Brachiopods

Extant brachiopods in their natural habitat

Characteristics- Brachiopods are marine invertebrates having a shell similar to that of bivalves. Unlike bivalves they have a line of symmetry splitting the valves down the middle instead of along the commissure. Brachiopods mostly bind to the sea bed using a fleshy stalk called a pedicle. They filter food using a ciliated tentacle called lophophore.

Natural occurrence – They are mostly found in a variety of marine environmentsfrom tropical to polar oceans. They are rarely found at turbulent coastlines where bivalves such as clams dominate. Instead they are found in deep, colder and steady water where they live attached to rocks, shells, or the seafloor

Fun fact –While externally they closely resemble bivalves. Taxonomically they are not classified under bivalvia. In fact they are not even classified under mollusca and are part of their own separate group**.**